

# Using the Feature-Rich Ionic Framework for Hybrid Mobile App Development

Ionic is a framework and SDK for developing hybrid mobile apps. It wipes out the cumbersome task of creating mobile apps separately for each different operating system. Ionic gives hybrid apps that native feel, which is so appreciated.



grew into full-fledged HTML, CSS, and JS Web apps when AngularJS was introduced. The arrival of AngularJS proved to be the tipping point for the switch to hybrid app development. This, in turn, spurred the development of frameworks that bridged the gap in using these technologies specifically for hybrid applications, one of which was the Ionic Framework.

## The Ionic Framework

The Ionic Framework eliminated the need for developers to quickly learn new skills when switching from Web to application development. It offers not only the now popular MV\* framework (such as MVC), but also reusable UI components that make it practically a day's work to build, test, deploy and monitor a full-fledged application.

Hybrid application development was first thrust into the limelight back in 2011 when Facebook tried to build an iOS application in HTML5. Many argued that this example proved hybrid applications could only offer a clunky UI, limited capabilities and terrible performance. However, this was nearly a decade back. Today, the technologies utilised in hybrid application development provide comparable performance to most native applications. Projects like Apache Cordova and the Ionic Framework are already hugely popular, with active development communities, while others such as Phonegap are catching on.

Following the rise in popularity, SMEs have focused on expanding use cases for hybrid applications. A few of the Apple Store's 'Best of 2017 iOS Applications' were built using the

**T**here was a time, not so long ago, when applications had to be tailored to the platform they were built for. This was a challenge for small scale businesses and even some large scale ones, as it simply was not feasible to employ teams of people building exactly the same product for different mobile operating systems. Then came hybrid apps!

A hybrid application is one that is developed in a manner that enables a single product to function on multiple platforms, providing a seamless experience to the users. More importantly, it reduces the effort that would otherwise be required of developers to build native apps for all the platforms their consumers utilise. What started with simple Web views,